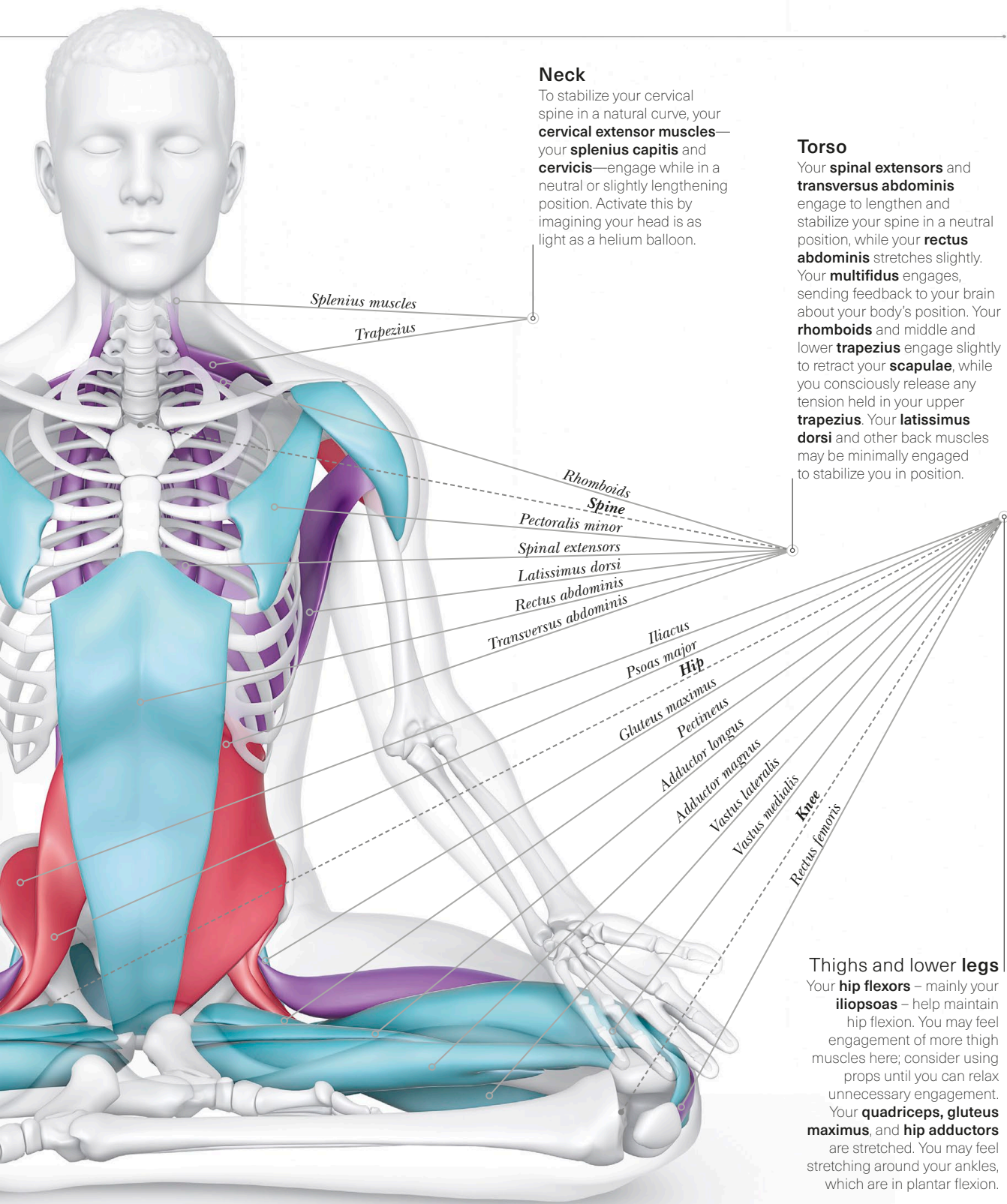




## Neck

To stabilize your cervical spine in a natural curve, your **cervical extensor muscles**—your **splenius capitis** and **cervicis**—engage while in a neutral or slightly lengthening position. Activate this by imagining your head is as light as a helium balloon.

## Torso

Your **spinal extensors** and **transversus abdominis** engage to lengthen and stabilize your spine in a neutral position, while your **rectus abdominis** stretches slightly. Your **multifidus** engages, sending feedback to your brain about your body's position. Your **rhomboids** and middle and lower **trapezius** engage slightly to retract your **scapulae**, while you consciously release any tension held in your upper **trapezius**. Your **latissimus dorsi** and other back muscles may be minimally engaged to stabilize you in position.

## Thighs and lower legs

Your **hip flexors** – mainly your **iliopsoas** – help maintain hip flexion. You may feel engagement of more thigh muscles here; consider using props until you can relax unnecessary engagement. Your **quadriceps**, **gluteus maximus**, and **hip adductors** are stretched. You may feel stretching around your ankles, which are in plantar flexion.